ARCHANGELX – COMPLETE OPERATOR-LEVEL EXPLANATION

(From account rules → entries → grid behavior → exits → risk kill-switches)

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0. The Mental Model (Read This First)

ArchAngelX is **not** a simple grid EA and **not** a pure indicator strategy.

Operationally, it is:

> **A conditional exposure engine** that
>
> - waits for acceptable market conditions
> - deploys a grid in a controlled sequence
> - dynamically adjusts price spacing and size
> - manages trades as a basket
> - and shuts itself down when risk limits are touched

Everything in the settings exists to answer **one question**:

> *"When is it acceptable to add exposure, and when must exposure be frozen or killed?"*

If you understand that, the rest becomes mechanical.

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1. Account-Level Risk Control (Equity Protector)

This is the **outer safety shell**. Nothing inside this matters if this layer is wrong.

Max Running Loss ($)

This is the **maximum floating drawdown allowed on OPEN trades**.

Operationally:

- When floating loss reaches this number
- The EA **immediately disables itself**
- No new trades
- Depending on restart logic, it may restart later

This is **not** your Apex trailing DD.
This is **your internal airbag**.

For Apex:

- Trailing DD: $2,500
- Your internal cap: $1,500
  Correct.

This parameter should **always** be tighter than Apex's trailing DD.

Restart EA After Loss

Defines how the EA recovers *after* it trips the Max Running Loss.

Two philosophies:

- **Restart next day** → conservative, professional
- **Restart after X hours** → aggressive, faster payout, higher risk

For funded accounts:

- Restarting the same day increases revenge-risk
- Restart next day keeps equity curve smoother (better for consistency)

Daily Profit Target ($)

If hit:

- All trades close
- EA disables
- EA restarts next day

This is **anti-overtrading**, not profit maximization.

On Apex:

- This helps avoid violating the **30% consistency rule**
- Prevents “one big day” dominating payout math

Ultimate Target Balance

Once hit:

- EA shuts down permanently
- No restart

This is your **“mission accomplished” switch**.

For payout runs:

- Set this exactly at payout level
- Prevents giving profits back

Global Equity Stop (Absolute / % / Risked)

This is a **hard equity line in the sand**.

Operationally:

- If equity hits this level
- All trades close
- EA stops completely

This is stronger than Max Running Loss and usually redundant if MRD is set correctly.

Min Seconds Between Trades

This throttles execution frequency.

For grids:

- Too low = trade spam during volatility spikes
- Too high = missed recovery entries

For Apex:

- This prevents burst-execution during fast markets

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2. Lot Size & Position Scaling (How Risk Grows)

This section controls **how fast exposure compounds**.

Lot Size

This is the **base size of the first trade** in a sequence.

Everything scales off this.

For futures-mapped symbols (NQ/ES/MGC):

- This determines how quickly floating PnL moves per tick
- Small changes here have **large downstream effects**

Risk % (Usually OFF)

This is designed for **single-trade systems**, not grids.

In grid context:

- Risk % + no fixed SL = undefined behavior
- Generally leave OFF

Lot Size Exponent (LSE)

This is **the engine of grid aggression**.

How it works:

- Each new trade = previous lot × exponent
- 1.0 = flat size
- 1.0 = compounding
- 2.0 = martingale

Operational reality:

- Higher LSE closes grids faster
- But accelerates drawdown brutally if price trends

For Apex:

- Anything above ~1.2 on NQ is dangerous unless spacing is very wide

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Max Lot Size

This is your **exposure ceiling**.

No matter what:

- The EA will not exceed this lot size

This is one of the **most important safety controls**.

Correct use:

- Allow initial scaling
- Cap tail risk

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3. Compounding Logic (Optional, Advanced)

This adjusts lot size dynamically as account equity grows.

Use Compounding?

If ON:

- Lot size
- Max lot
- Max running loss
  are all **scaled relative to a balance threshold**

This is useful for:

- Growing personal accounts

- NOT ideal for Apex, where trailing DD resets behaviorally

For payout runs:

- Usually OFF

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4. Money Management (How Trades Exit)

This controls **how baskets are closed**, not individual trades.

TakeProfit (Pips or ATR)

Important detail:

- TP is applied to the **entire sequence**, not individual trades
- TP is calculated from the **average entry price**

Operationally:

- Larger TP = fewer closes, longer holds
- Smaller TP = frequent closes, smoother equity

ATR-based TP:

- Adapts to volatility
- Safer across regimes

StopLoss (Pips or ATR)

Each trade gets its own SL **if this is enabled**.

Grid operators often:

- Leave this wide
- Rely on Max Running Loss instead

Be careful:

- Tight SL + grid logic can create death-by-cuts

Lock Profit (Breakeven Logic)

This is where ArchAngelX becomes professional.

How it works:

- Once price moves X pips beyond breakeven
- A trailing mechanism activates
- Protects the basket

This converts grids from:

- “Hope price returns”
  to
- “Harvest partial mean reversion”

Lock Profit – When to Check

- Every tick → fastest, noisier
- On bar close → cleaner, slower

For fast instruments (NQ):

- Tick-based is acceptable
  For slower ones (ES):
- Bar-close is cleaner

Trailing Stoploss

Once lock profit triggers:

- Trailing SL follows price
- Locks in gains

This prevents:

- Large winners turning into losers
- Post-news reversals wiping baskets

Allow Same Pair & Direction Trades

When running multiple instances:

- This prevents stacking multiple grids in the same direction

For Apex:

- **Strongly recommended**
- Prevents correlated blowups

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5. Grid Construction & Sequencing (Core Behavior)

This is **where most EAs die** if misunderstood.

Pip Step

Distance between grid trades.

- Small step = fast recovery, high risk
- Large step = slower recovery, safer

This is your **exposure density control**.

Pip Step Exponent

This is **anti-martingale spacing**.

Instead of:
10 → 10 → 10
You get:
10 → 15 → 22.5 → …

This is critical for:

- Trend survival
- Apex compliance

Max Pip Step

Caps how wide spacing can grow.

Prevents:

- Infinite spacing
- “Never recovers” grids

Delay Trade Sequence

This delays the **start of real exposure**.

Operationally:

- EA waits for price to move further before committing capital
- Reduces early drawdown
- Improves entry quality

This is extremely powerful when combined with RSI/EMA.

Live Delay

Instead of ignoring early trades:

- EA **queues them**
- Then executes them all at once later

This creates:

- Stronger average entry
- But sudden exposure bursts

For Apex:

- Use carefully
- Combine with tight Max Running Loss

Lot Multiplier After Live Delay

Allows overweighting the first real trade after delay.

This is aggressive.
Use sparingly.

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6. Trading Sessions & Time Control

This defines **when risk is allowed to exist**.

Custom Trading Times (Per Day)

EA only trades during defined windows.

For Apex NY session:

- This avoids Asian chop
- Avoids overnight trend drift

Action at End of Session

Options:

- Close all trades
- Wait for sequence to close
- Pause and leave trades open

For funded accounts:

- **Wait for sequence to close** is usually safest
- Forced closure can crystallize losses

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7. Weekend Closure

This is mandatory.

Holding grids over weekend:

- Gap risk
- No control
- Apex nightmare

Always:

- Close before weekend
- Restart after open

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8. Indicator Filters (When Trades Are Allowed)

Indicators do **not** predict price here.
They **permit or block exposure**.

Bollinger Bands

Used to detect **extremes**.

Modes:

- Avoid Extreme → don’t buy tops or sell bottoms
- Only Extreme Counter-Trend → trade only at stretched levels

This protects grids from:

- Entering mid-trend

- Fighting momentum too early

ADX

Measures **trend strength**, not direction.

Rules:

- Trade with trend only → momentum mode
- Avoid opposite trend → range mode

ADX is critical for:

- Preventing grid deployment during strong trends

EMA

Defines **directional bias**.

Price relative to EMA stack determines:

- Long only
- Short only
- Both

EMA + ADX together define:

- Trend regime
- Range regime

RSI

Used as **timing**, not direction.

- Overbought → short entries allowed
- Oversold → long entries allowed

RSI + Delay is extremely powerful:

- Waits for exhaustion
- Then commits capital

Double Check EMA / ADX for First Real Trade

If using delay:

- This re-checks conditions before real exposure

This prevents:

- Fake setups
- Late trend continuation entries

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9. News Filter (Regime Break Protection)

This is the **final kill switch**.

Use High Impact News Filter

If ON:

- EA pauses or exits around scheduled news

This is **mandatory** for NQ.

News Trades Action

Two options:

- Manage open trades
- Close all trades and disable

For Apex:

- Closing trades before major news is safest
- Managing is acceptable only if exposure is shallow

Close X Hours Before / Pause X Hours After

This defines:

- How early risk is removed
- How long EA waits before re-entering

Post-news chop kills grids.
Cooldown matters.

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10. Final Operational Truth

ArchAngelX is not dangerous by default.
It becomes dangerous when **too many aggressive levers are pulled at once**.

The most common failure pattern is:

Tight spacing

- High lot exponent

- No ADX filter
- No news filter
- NQ volatility
  = Apex account gone